

ILLUSTRATED GLOSSARY

Included in this glossary are a series of key terms, organized alphabetically, that relate to the history of fashion and dress. Date ranges are given for each term, with a "▷" indicating that the garment or technique continues to the present day. Glossary entries that appear within the text are italicized.

NATIONAL DRESS

Panels on the following pages examine examples of traditional dress from around the world. Key elements of the national costume are defined in the glossary.



American cowboy

Cowboy hats and denim have been linked to cowboys since the 19th century, and their popularity persists today among ranchers in the US and Canada.

A

ACCESSORIES Items such as hats, gloves, and jewellery that are worn or carried to complete an outfit.

ACCORDION PLEATS A series of narrow, evenly spaced *pleats* with alternating raised and recessed edges, allowing the garment to expand or flare with movement.
19TH CENTURY: SEE P.323

ACETATE A light, *silky* synthetic fibre made from cellulose, obtained from wood pulp; invented in Germany.
19TH CENTURY ▷

ACID-WASHING A technique often used on *denim*; involves washing garments together with pumice stones that have been soaked in chlorine, which gives the fabric a worn, mottled look.
1980s ▷

ACRYLIC A synthetic fibre made from a petrochemical product and used like *wool*; trade names include Acrilan, Courtelle, Orlon.
1940s

AESTHETIC DRESS Style inspired by historic dress (following on from *Artistic dress*) and Oriental clothing such as *kimonos*; involved use of natural fabric dyes and of traditional or nature-inspired patterns; see also *Liberty print*; *Paisley*.
LATE 19TH CENTURY:
SEE PP.212–4, 336–7

AGLETS, AIGLETS Metal sheaths used at the end of the ties that join *hose* to a *doublet*; now refers to the sheaths at the end of shoelaces.

13TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.71, 94

AIGRETTE Feather plume or feather-shaped ornament for headwear.

LATE 18TH–EARLY 20TH CENTURY

AKETON Quilted *tunic* worn under armour for comfort and protection.
13TH–15TH CENTURY: SEE P.69

ALB Ankle-length vestment of white *linen* with long-sleeves and a cord tied at the waist; worn by clerics and monks in the Christian Church.

MEDIEVAL: SEE P.57

À LA DISPOSITION Term used for a design printed or embroidered on, or woven into a fabric so it can be made up into a specific garment.
1850s ▷: SEE P.205

ALBERT COLLAR A detachable *stand collar* fastened to a man's shirt by a button at the back.
1850s–EARLY 20TH CENTURY

A-LINE A triangular dress shape created by Christian Dior (see also *H-line*, *Y-line*), or generally a dress or skirt flared like the sides of an "A".
MID-1950s ▷: SEE PP.319, 455

ALOHA SHIRT Traditional Hawaiian shirt for men, with short sleeves and made from colourful fabric; worn as semi-formal clothing in Hawaii.
1930s ▷



ALPACA Fine, soft fibre obtained from the alpaca (a South American relation of the llama) and woven or *knitted* like *wool*.

ANDROGYNOUS STYLE Adoption of masculine *jackets*, trousers, and suits by women, notably Marlene Dietrich and Katharine Hepburn in the 1930s and Patti Smith in the 1970s.
1930s ▷: SEE PP.288, 372–3

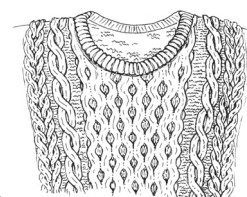
ANGORA (a) name of the goat whose fleece is used for *mohair*; (b) light, *silky* fibre from the Angora rabbit, used like *wool*.

ANILINE DYE The first form of synthetic dye; mauveine, one of the first, was discovered by British scientist William Perkins, who used it to make the colour mauve; also notably used to make the colours purple, magenta, pink, and green.
1850s ▷

ANORAK A hooded *jacket* originally made of animal skin or waterproofed cloth, and worn by the indigenous peoples in Greenland and Canada; now refers to a hooded, weatherproof *jacket* usually made of synthetic fibre with synthetic or down insulation; see also *Parka*.

APPLIQUÉ Decorative technique in which cut-out fabric shapes are sewn on to a larger piece of fabric or garment to form a design.
SEE PP.180, 207, 236

ARAN Style of *knitwear* originating among families in the Aran Islands off the



Irish coast; made from undyed *wool* and featuring intricate raised patterns such as *cables* and *twists*.

ARGYLE PATTERN Scottish pattern comprising diamond shapes in two or more colours; made popular by golfers, now common on jumpers and socks.
1920s ▷